

GENERAL.

Action by
General Medi-
cal Council.

15. The General Medical Council may, for the purposes of section three of the principal Act, act through their Executive Committee instead of through the English Branch Council.

Short title,
construction,
commence-
ment, and
repeal.

16.—(1) This Act may be cited as the Midwives Act, 1918, and shall be construed with the principal Act; and that Act and this Act may be cited together as the Midwives Acts, 1902 and 1918.

(2) This Act shall come into operation on the first day of January nineteen hundred and nineteen.

(3) The provisions of the principal Act specified in the Schedule to this Act are hereby repealed.

SCHEDULE.

Section 16.

PROVISIONS OF PRINCIPAL ACT REPEALED.

In section 5 the words “in proportion to the number of midwives who have given notice during the year of their intention to practise in those areas respectively.”

Section 9 the whole section.

In section 10 the words “or to the body to whom for the time being the powers and duties of the local supervising authority shall have been delegated under this Act,” and the words “or delegated body.”

Section 17 from “The General Medical Council” to the end of the section.

CHAPTER 44.

An Act to constitute a Special Commission to inquire into certain complaints as to the Treatment of Prisoners in Belfast Prison. [21st November 1918.]

BE it enacted by the King’s most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

Appoint-
ment
of Commis-
sioner.

1.—(1) The Right Honourable William Huston Dodd, one of the Judges of the King’s Bench Division of His Majesty’s High Court of Justice in Ireland, is hereby appointed Commissioner for the purpose of inquiring into, and reporting upon, such complaints as to the treatment of prisoners in Belfast Prison in the months of June and July, nineteen hundred and eighteen, as may be presented to the Commissioner in accordance with the procedure which he may prescribe.

(2) In the event of the said Right Honourable William Huston Dodd dying before the completion of the report or being unable through illness or other sufficient cause to enter upon or to complete the inquiry and report, the Lord Chancellor of

Ireland may, with the consent of any other judge of the said court, appoint that judge Commissioner for the purposes aforesaid or such of them as have not been effected, in the place of the said Right Honourable William Huston Dodd, and may exercise the like power if and so often as any such event occurs in the case of any Commissioner appointed by him.

(3) In this Act the expression "the Commissioner" includes the Commissioner appointed by this Act and any Commissioner appointed by the Lord Chancellor in pursuance of this Act.

2. The court held by the Commissioner for the purposes of the inquiry shall be a court of record, and the Commissioner for the purposes aforesaid shall have all such powers, rights, and privileges as are vested in His Majesty's High Court of Justice in Ireland or in any judge thereof, on the occasion of any action save as respects judgment, execution, or costs, and in addition shall have power, if he thinks fit, to enforce the attendance of any person who, in the opinion of the Commissioner, should be examined as a witness, and to examine such person on oath, and the procedure shall be such as may be prescribed by the Commissioner.

3.—(1) A person examined as a witness under this Act shall not be excused from answering any question put to him, or from producing any document, on the ground that the answer thereto or production thereof may criminate or tend to criminate him, but any answer so given shall not be evidence against that person in any criminal proceeding (including a proceeding by court-martial) at any time thereafter instituted against him, and any document so produced shall not be evidence against him in any such proceeding unless the production of that document could be enforced in those proceedings or evidence of that document could be otherwise obtained in any such proceedings.

(2) Nothing in this section shall apply to the case of proceedings for having given false evidence before the Commissioner, or for having procured, or attempted or conspired to procure, the giving of such evidence.

4. This Act may be cited as the Special Commission (Belfast Prison) Act, 1918.

CHAPTER 45.

An Act to extend the purposes for which the Gas Contingent Guarantee Rate under the Burghs Gas Supply (Scotland) Act, 1876, may be levied. [21st November 1918.]

BE it enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows :